

SESSION 1 RUNBOOK: FOLLOW STEP BY STEP

GATE CHECK: SB 577 + Recording Consent SIGNED? → If NO: collect verbal consent on camera. Do NOT record without consent. Do NOT proceed to trance without completing Step 4 (Screening).

STEP 1: WARM-UP

2-3 MIN

SAY: "T.M., welcome. Good to see you. Before we get into anything clinical, how was your day?"

DO: Let him talk. 2-3 minutes of normal human conversation. Match his energy. Be warm, direct. Do NOT start clinical mode yet.

SAY: "Good. Thank you for making the time tonight. I know it takes courage to try something new."

STEP 2: SESSION FRAME

2 MIN

SAY: "Here is how tonight works. We are going to do four things. First, we talk. I want to hear what brought you here. Second, I ask some screening questions. Third, I run a suggestibility assessment. Fourth, if you are comfortable, we do a first relaxation experience. Sound good?"

STEP 3: L.O.V.E. INTAKE (LISTEN, OBSERVE, VERIFY, EMPATHIZE)

10-15 MIN

ASK: "Tell me what brought you here. In your own words. Take your time."

DO: LISTEN. Do not interrupt. Note his exact words for each theme. Watch body language, vocal shifts, eye contact.

IF: *He goes quiet: "You can share as much or as little as you're comfortable with tonight."*

SAY: "Thank you for sharing that. That takes courage, especially with someone new."

SAY: "I want to make sure I heard you correctly. You've been working on this in psychotherapy, and it helped significantly. But the self-esteem, the trust, the hypervigilance, the feeling of not being comfortable in your own skin — those are still running. Is that accurate?"

DO: Let him correct you. His corrections tell you what matters most. Use HIS words going forward.

SAY: "That sounds exhausting. Carrying that level of alertness every day, even when you know you are safe now."

DO: EMPATHIZE: one sentence showing you FEEL the weight. Then explore.

ASK: "Can you give me a specific recent example? A situation where you noticed the anxiety or hypervigilance showing up?"

ASK: "When the anxiety is running the show, where do you feel that in your body? Is there a physical sensation?"

RECORD: Body location of anxiety: _____ (chest? stomach? jaw? nowhere?)

STEP 4: CHECK EXPECTATIONS

3 MIN

ASK: "What are you expecting from hypnotherapy? What do you think will be different from the psychotherapy you've done?"

ASK: "What do you already understand about these reactions, and what would you like to be different?"

ASK: "What are you hoping hypnotherapy will add to the work you've already done?"

RECORD: His answer to the last question (verbatim): _____

SAY: "The therapy you've done already made real progress. Those are genuine gains. What we do here is add an experiential layer — in a deeply relaxed state, your mind becomes more open to experiencing things differently. We're building on what you've accomplished."

ASK: "Does that make sense? Does that match what you're looking for?"

IF: *No: explore further. Do NOT proceed until aligned.*

STEP 5: CO-CREATE PLAN

3 MIN

SAY: "Based on what you've shared, here's what I'm hearing. You have six things that are interconnected — self-esteem, confidence, assertiveness, trust, anxiety, and letting go. And underneath all of them, experiences from childhood that encoded certain patterns."

SAY: "I propose we work together for six to eight sessions. Tonight is assessment. Next sessions, we go deeper. By session four or five, we build your independence. By session six, if things are tracking well, we graduate."

ASK: "Does that pace feel right? Is there anything you'd want to prioritize?"

RECORD: His priority: _____

STEP 6: CRITICAL SCREENING

5-10 MIN

SAY: "I need to ask you some screening questions. Standard for every client, especially important given what you've shared. I need honest answers so we can work safely."

ASK: Q1: "Are you currently seeing a therapist, psychologist, or psychiatrist?"

RECORD: Active care: Y/N. If Y, name + type: _____

ASK: Q2: "Are you currently taking any medications? Anything for anxiety, depression, sleep?"

If anti-psychotic: STOP. REFER. Do not proceed.

RECORD: Medications: _____

ASK: Q3: "I need to ask this directly. Have you ever had thoughts of harming yourself or ending your life?"

If ACTIVE: STOP. Provide 988. REFER. Do not proceed.

RECORD: Safety: Active / Past-resolved / Never

ASK: Q4: "You mentioned experiences from when you were young. Without needing to share details — was this a single event or something over time? Did it involve physical harm, emotional harm, or both?"

DO: Scope only. Do NOT push for details he's not ready to share.

RECORD: Trauma scope: Single / Ongoing. Physical / Emotional / Both. Who: _____

ASK: Q5: "Is there anything I should be careful about? Words, topics, imagery that trigger strong reactions?"

RECORD: Triggers: _____

ASK: Q6: "Do you experience panic attacks? And when very stressed, do you ever feel like you're watching yourself from the outside?"

RECORD: Panic: Y/N, frequency: _____. Dissociation: Y/N

SAY: "Thank you. Everything stays confidential, with two exceptions: immediate danger or abuse of a minor or elder."

SAY: "One thing to be aware of — because this is through the community service program, I may discuss our session with a clinical supervisor for educational purposes. Your identity is always protected. Is that okay?"

RECORD: CSP supervision acknowledged: Y/N

STEP 7: PRE-INDUCTION SPEECH

3-5 MIN

SAY: "Let me tell you what hypnosis is and what it is not."

SAY: "Hypnosis is a natural state. You go in and out of it throughout your day — when you're absorbed in a movie, driving a familiar route on autopilot, or deep in a conversation and lose track of time."

SAY: "Deep Sleep is a trigger word I'll use. It is not actual sleep. It is a deeply relaxed state with your eyes closed. You will not go unconscious. You will not lose control. You will be aware the entire time — possibly more aware than usual."

SAY: "You would not do or say anything you wouldn't in your wide-awake state. This is not a truth serum. You may wonder if you are in hypnosis — and that is usually when you know you are."

SAY: "You will hear everything. Your mind may wander. That is normal. Your subconscious will know when to return to my voice."

SAY: "Some people feel light and tingly. Some feel heavy. Some just feel relaxed and calm. Whatever you experience is right for you."

SAY: "This is a 'do with' process, not a 'do to' process. It is cooperative. It requires your active participation. Today we start the process of positive change."

STEP 8: THEORY OF MIND

5 MIN

DO: Draw or show the circle diagram as you talk.

SAY: "Let me draw you a picture of how your mind works."

SAY: "At the bottom: the primitive area. Fight or flight. Your basic survival instinct. It makes decisions in milliseconds."

SAY: "From birth to about age eight, everything goes in as absolute truth. Positive and negative. These become your known associations — your programming."

SAY: "These associations make up your subconscious mind — about 88 percent of your total mind power."

SAY: "As you get older, you develop the critical mind — a filter that protects those known associations."

SAY: "Then you develop logic, reasoning, decision-making, and willpower — the one that doesn't work when you want it to. This is your conscious mind. Only about 12 percent."

SAY: "When you decide to change something, the thought goes from your conscious mind down through the critical mind. If your subconscious programming resists, the critical mind blocks it. Same behavior continues."

SAY: "What hypnosis does is bypass the critical mind. We get direct access to the subconscious and use positive suggestions to make the changes you want."

SAY: "I work with the 88 percent. You work with the 12 percent. Together, we have 100 percent."

SAY: "The patterns you described — the hypervigilance, the trust issues, the anxiety running the show — those live in the 88 percent. Your conscious mind knows better. The subconscious hasn't caught up. That is what we update."

STEP 9: SUGGESTIBILITY TEST

5-10 MIN

SAY: "I am going to test your suggestibility to see how you take information in. This is one test you cannot pass or fail, so please don't help me in any way."

SAY: "You don't need to talk. If the answer is yes, nod. If no, shake your head. If you don't know, just stare at me."

DO: Administer all 36 questions. Score Physical/Emotional split.

DO: Finger-spread demo: "Raise your arm. Palm in front of your face, fingers above eye level. Stare at your middle finger. Deep breath — and on the exhale, your fingers begin to separate. Separating, wider and wider, farther apart."

DO: Repeat 3-8 times. Note speed and spread. Test other arm. Compare.

RECORD: EP Result: Physical ____% / Emotional ____%

IF PHYSICAL: "You scored [X]% Physical. Your subconscious responds best to direct, specific language. When I say 'your hand IS rising,' it rises. Literal, concrete, no ambiguity."
IF EMOTIONAL: "You scored [X]% Emotional. Your subconscious works through inference. Instead of telling you what to experience, I suggest possibilities and your mind fills in what's right."
IF BALANCED: "You scored roughly balanced. That gives us flexibility. We'll find the right mix."

STEP 10: PHYSIOLOGICAL CHANGES + CONSENT

2 MIN

SAY: "As you enter the hypnotic state, you will notice changes in your body. I will notice them before you do."

SAY: "Are you comfortable proceeding with the relaxation exercise? There is no pressure."

IF: *He hesitates: "We can absolutely wait. There is no timeline."*

SAY: "If at any point you want to pause, raise your right index finger. I will bring you back immediately."

SAY: "Take a deep breath in through your nose. Hold it. And exhale slowly through your mouth. One more."

STEP 11: ARM-RAISING INDUCTION

5-8 MIN

DO: Start timer now.

PHYSICAL EP:

SAY: "Raise your arm. Elbow on the table. Palm facing your face. Fingers straight up, above eye level. Stare at your middle finger."
SAY: "Deep breath. As your elbow presses down, the muscles in your upper arm tighten and pull. From your elbow to your fingertips, your hand begins to lift. Higher and higher. Lighter and lighter. Light as a feather."
SAY: "Lifting, rising, pulling, jerking. With every breath, higher. Lighter. Moving up."
SAY: "Your hand starts to twist and turn inward. A magnetic pull — hand toward face, head toward hand."
SAY: "When your hand touches your face, nod your head. At that moment you reach the peak of your suggestibility."
WAIT for touch + nod. SNAP: "DEEP SLEEP."

EMOTIONAL EP:

SAY: "Place your arm on the table. Close your eyes. Imagine your hand becoming lighter. Very light. As light as a feather. And then even lighter."
SAY: "At the same time, your other hand feels heavier against your leg. Feel your feet on the floor. Your back against the chair."
SAY: "The light hand is lifting, rising, twisting, turning upward. I wonder if you'd say the hand is being drawn to the head, or the head to the hand. I'll let you decide."
SAY: "When your hand touches your face, nod. You will reach your peak of suggestibility."
WAIT for touch + nod. SNAP: "DEEP SLEEP."

SAY: PHS: "Each and every time I suggest the words Deep Sleep to you, for the purpose of hypnosis and with your permission, you will enter this state very quickly, calmly, safely and comfortably, and deeply, and the physical body will relax."

RECORD: Induction time: __ min __ sec

STEP 12: 5-0 COUNT

2 MIN

SAY: "Hand down gently. Five — we are going down now, deeper into the state of hypnosis. Four — physically releasing, relaxing. Three — an emotional calmness. Two — mentally relaxing now. One — going deeper. And zero — Deep Sleep."

SAY: PHS: "Each and every time... safely and comfortably... physical body relaxes."

STEP 13: HAND-TO-FOREHEAD CHALLENGE

2 MIN

IF: PHYSICAL EP ONLY. Skip for Emotional.

SAY: "Your hand is still connected to your forehead. Solid. Like two magnets pressed together. Try to pull it away — and notice it will not move."

DO: Brief test, 3-5 seconds.

SAY: "Stop trying. 5-4-3-2-1-0. Deep Sleep. Twice as deep."

SAY: PHS.

STEP 14: REACTIONAL DEEPENER

2 MIN

SAY: "Open your eyes."

DO: Wait 2 seconds.

SAY: "Deep Sleep. Twice as deep."

SAY: "Open your eyes."

DO: Wait 2 seconds.

SAY: "Deep Sleep. Twice as deep. Comfortable. Safe."

SAY: PHS.

Only 2 cycles for trauma client. Do not overload.

STEP 15: HEAVY/LIGHT (OPTIONAL)

2 MIN

IF: Physical EP only. Skip if running long or client is fatiguing.

SAY: "Arms out. One palm up. Other thumb to ceiling. Close your eyes. Heavy bag of sand on the open palm, pressing down. Helium balloons on the thumb, pulling up."

DO: Pause 10 seconds. Observe differential movement.

SAY: "Release. Arms down. Deep Sleep. Twice as deep."

SAY: PHS.

STEP 16: PROGRESSIVE RELAXATION

5 MIN

START RECORDING HERE.

SAY: "Now as you relax, you feel the rhythm of your breath. You feel connected inside. You are giving yourself permission to allow me to guide you."

SAY: "Bring your attention to the top of your head. [Pause.] A sense of relaxation washing down over your scalp. [Pause.] Forehead. [Pause.] Temples. [Pause.] Eyelids. [Pause.] Cheeks. [Pause.] Relaxing your jaw. [Pause.]"

SAY: "Pay no attention to any outside sounds, except my voice. These outside sounds are everyday sounds and cannot disturb you but will tend to relax you even deeper."

SAY: "Neck muscles release. [Pause.] Shoulders soften. [Pause.] Upper arms. [Pause.] Elbows. [Pause.] Forearms. [Pause.] Wrists. [Pause.] Hands. [Pause.] All the way to the tips of your fingers. [Pause.]"

SAY: "Chest opens. [Pause.] Solar plexus. [Pause.] Belly area unwinding. [Pause.] Breathing becomes deep, gentle, rhythmic. [Pause.] The drowsy, relaxed feeling takes over. [Pause.]"

SAY: "Hips. [Pause.] Pelvis releasing. [Pause.] Thighs. [Pause.] Knees. [Pause.] Shins. [Pause.] Calves. [Pause.] Ankles. [Pause.] Heels. [Pause.] Arches. [Pause.] Every single toe. [Pause.]"

SAY: "5. [Long pause.] 4. [Long pause.] 3. [Long pause.] 2. [Long pause.] 1. [Long pause.] 0. Deep Sleep."

SAY: PHS.

STEP 17: STAIRCASE (20 STEPS)

3 MIN

SAY: "You are standing at the top of a beautiful staircase. Well-lit. Sturdy handrails. Twenty steps leading down. With each step, deeper and more relaxed."

SAY: "Left foot 19, right foot 18. Twice as deep at 17. 16. 15. 14. 13. Twice as deep at 12. 11. 10. Letting go at 9. 8. Twice as deep at 7. 6. 5. Deeper still at 4. 3. 2. 1. 0. Deep Sleep."

SAY: "At the bottom, a door. Open it. Step through. Close it behind you. You are in a warm, open, sunlit space. No walls. No ceiling. Just safety and openness."

SAY: PHS.

STEP 18: SAFE SPACE BUILDING

5 MIN

SAY: "Now create a room. This room belongs entirely to you. No one else has been here. Not a memory. Not a place from your past. Something new."

PHYSICAL: "What color are the walls? What's on the floor? Is there a window? What do you see through it?"
EMOTIONAL: "Allow the space to take shape on its own. Notice colors... textures... the feeling of the space."

ASK: "What does the temperature feel like? Any sounds? Any scent? Is there a place to sit?"

SAY: "Settle in. You decide what enters this space and what stays outside. This is your room."

SAY: "Subconscious mind, when this room is fully established and you feel completely safe, let a nod happen."

DO: Wait for nod. If none after 30 sec: "Take your time. When it feels ready, let it happen."

RECORD: Safe room description: _____

STEP 19: GROUNDING ANCHOR (TRIPLE-FIRE)

2 MIN

SAY: "Press your thumb and index finger together on your left hand. Feel that pressure. That sensation is now linked to this safety. This room. This calm."

DO: Fire 1. Pause.

SAY: "Release. Press again. The calm deepens. The room becomes more vivid."

DO: Fire 2. Pause.

SAY: "Release. One more. Press. Breathe in. As you exhale, all tension drains out through your feet."

DO: Fire 3.

SAY: "Subconscious mind, when this anchor is installed, let a nod happen."

DO: Wait for nod.

STEP 20: POST-HYPNOTIC SUGGESTION

1 MIN

SAY: "Between now and our next session, you may notice moments of unexpected calm. Moments where the anxiety is just a little lower. When those happen, notice them. Each one is evidence that this work is active."

STEP 21: COUNT OUT

2 MIN

SAY: PHS seal: "Each and every time... safely and comfortably... sealed now."

SAY: "Zero — let us close the door to the subconscious mind now, blocking all negatives."

SAY: "One — slowly coming up. Feeling your feet on the floor."

SAY: "Two — physically aware. Mentally alert."

SAY: "Three — coming up higher now."

SAY: "Four — eyes beginning to open."

SAY: "Five — EYES OPEN. WIDE AWAKE. 1-2-3-4-5 EYES OPEN AND WIDE AWAKE."

SAY: "Take a moment. There is no rush."

STOP RECORDING.

STEP 22: DEBRIEF + PHS VERIFY

5 MIN

ASK: "How do you feel?"

DO: Give him 30-60 seconds. Do not rush.

ASK: "What did you notice? Any images, sensations, feelings that stood out?"

ASK: "How deep would you say you went? Zero is wide awake, ten is the deepest possible."

RECORD: Self-reported depth: ___/10

SAY: PHS Verify: "Raise your arm. Palm facing you. Middle finger. Breathe. Fingers separating. Hand toward face. When it touches, nod. Deep Sleep."

DO: SNAP. Time the response.

RECORD: PHS verify time: ___ seconds (compare to induction)

DO: Count out 0-1-2-3-4-5 (gentle).

SAY: "Good. The suggestion is installed and working."

STEP 23: SMART BASELINES

3 MIN

SAY: "Before we wrap up, I want baseline numbers. Subjective. No wrong answers."

ASK: "How comfortable do you feel being yourself right now? 1 to 10."

RECORD: Self-esteem: ___/10

ASK: "How easy is it to set boundaries or say no? 1 to 10."

RECORD: Assertiveness: ___/10

ASK: "How much does anxiety affect your decisions? 1 is barely, 10 is everything."

RECORD: Anxiety: ___/10

ASK: "How much do you trust the people closest to you? 1 to 10."

RECORD: Trust: ___/10

ASK: "How often do you feel at ease without being on guard? 1 to 10."

RECORD: Comfort: ___/10

ASK: "How much does the past shape how you react? 1 is barely, 10 is everything."

RECORD: Past influence: ___/10

SAY: "Two things for homework. Just two."

SAY: "First: the grounding anchor. Thumb and finger, one deep breath. Use it whenever anxiety shows up. The more you use it, the stronger it gets."

SAY: "Second: at some point this week, sit quietly for two minutes, close your eyes, and visit the room you built tonight. Walk around it. Add a detail. Strengthen it."

SAY: "That's it. No journals, no tracking sheets. Just the anchor and the room."

ASK: "How are you feeling about everything we covered tonight?"

DO: Let him respond fully.

SAY: "You did really well. Your subconscious accepted the safe space and the anchor on the first session. That tells me your mind is ready for this work."

SAY: "Let's schedule session two. I'd suggest one to two weeks. What works?"

RECORD: Session 2 scheduled: __/__/__ at ____ PM

SAY: "Last thing. If anything feels overwhelming between now and then, use the anchor. And if it's urgent, call or text 988. That's the crisis line. You are not alone in this."

SAY: "Thank you for trusting me with this, T.M. See you at session two."

POST-SESSION: THERAPIST CHECKLIST

RECORD: EP: Physical __% / Emotional __%

RECORD: Induction time: __m __s. PHS verify: __s

RECORD: Depth (self-reported): __/10

RECORD: Safe room: _____

RECORD: Triggers: _____

RECORD: Medications: _____

RECORD: Trauma scope: _____

RECORD: Active care: _____

RECORD: 6 SMART baselines: SE__/_A__/_Anx__/_Tr__/_C__/_PI__

DO: Write SOAP notes (Subjective, Objective, Assessment, Plan)

DO: Update TM-002.json with EP, SOAP, session data

DO: Generate AVS: python scripts/generate_client_docs.py data/clients/TM-002.json

DO: Log CCH hours to HMI

DO: Reflect: what went well? What to adjust for S2?